Name: Jack Flax Date: _____

002B — Wednesday October 14 — Renaissance Art and Visual Language

DO NOW — Recall one humanist aim. Describe one visible detail in Creation of Adam.
- the goal was to echo artistic effect from Antiquity.

A. Painting — discuss

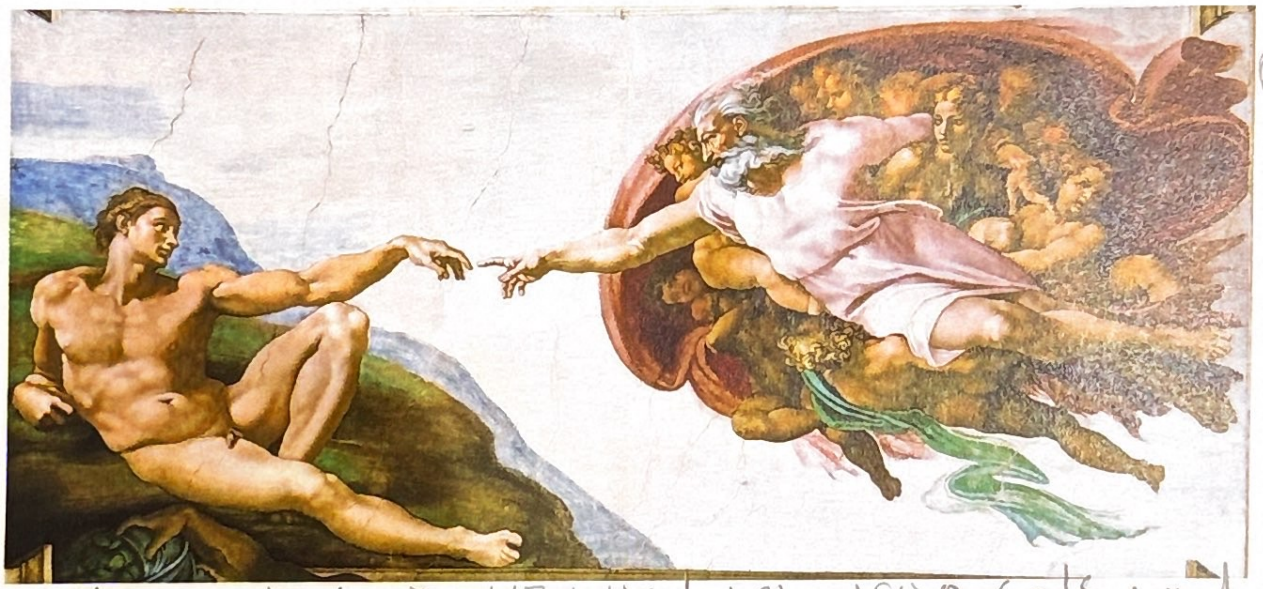
Painting first look — visual evidence before interpretation

- For each painting, describe only what you can see first: background or space, bodies, gestures, direction of attention, and any symbols. After that, connect the evidence to perspective, individual presence, and sacred or intellectual meaning.

After looking — painting interpretation

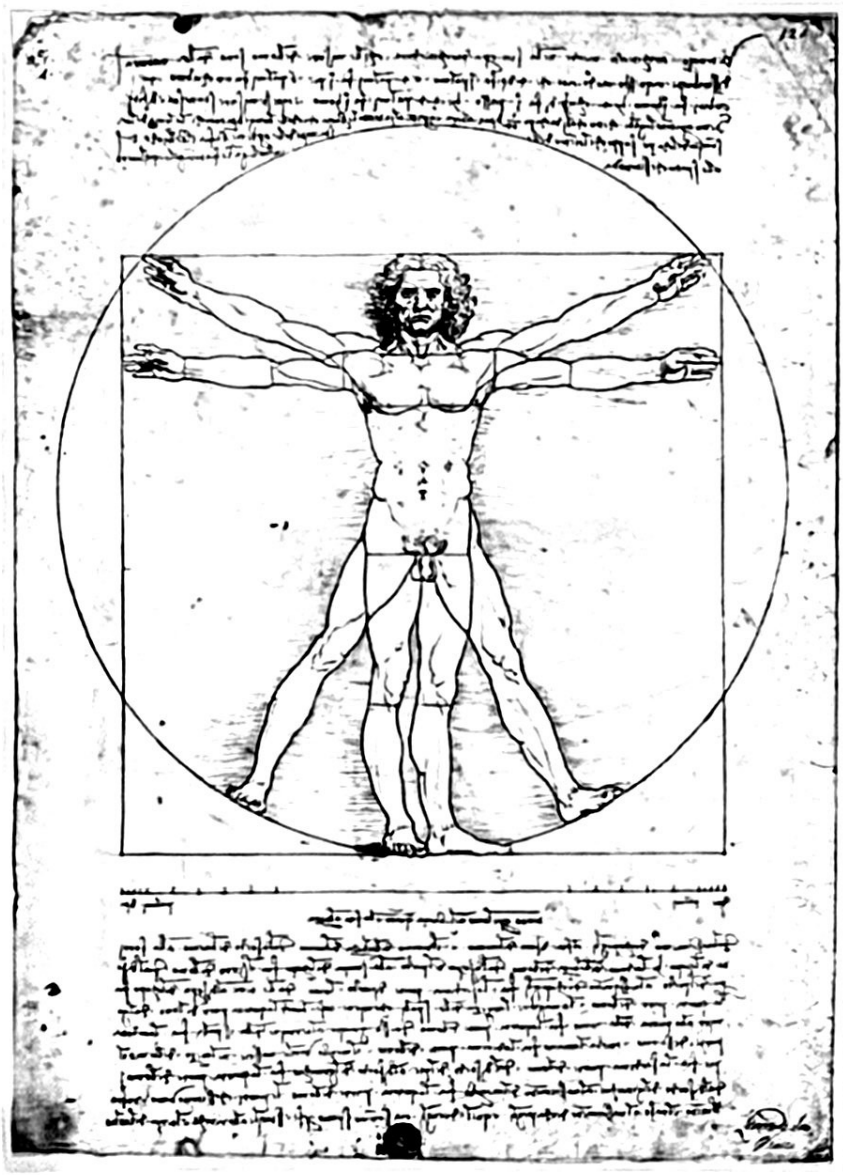
- Renaissance painters increasingly used linear perspective, modeling with light and shadow, close study of anatomy, and individualized faces or gestures. Religious subjects remained central; the new techniques gave sacred figures modeled bodies and placed them in continuous pictorial space.

Example 1 — Michelangelo, Creation of Adam (Sistine Chapel ceiling)
Describe the hands, poses, and space between the figures. How does Michelangelo connect God and Adam through their outstretched hands?



Adams hand is lazy, tired, not trying. Gods hand is fully extended, showing he's trying so hard for Adam. They are reaching out but not touching, both have realistic proportions

Example 2 — Leonardo da Vinci, Vitruvian Man (c. 1490)
Circle and square frame a measured human body. How does Leonardo connect the human body with geometry? Use a visible detail.



the perfect proportions for a man/woman fit into a perfect circle

Example 3 — Raphael, School of Athens (Stanza della Segnatura, Vatican)

human being = center of the world.



Before discussion: trace the architectural lines toward the central figures. Describe their gestures and one activity elsewhere in the image. How does the space organize those people?

Plato & Aristotle are walking & discussing something. One hand is up and the other extended forward. The group on the left on the stairs are writing & thinking while those on the right are using a compass. Maybe math?

MET PAINTING COMPARISON — Use the two Metropolitan Museum of Art images printed below: Raphael, Madonna and Child Enthroned with Saints, and Icon with Christ Pantokrator. Name one visible change in bodily weight or depth and one sacred feature that continues. Discuss orally.



Raphael, Madonna and Child Enthroned with Saints, ca. 1504. Oil and gold on wood. The Metropolitan Museum of Art.



Icon with Christ Pantokrator, Byzantine, 11th–12th century. Elephant ivory. The Metropolitan Museum of Art.

both Paintings Feature halos as a central object. The Madonna and Child has color, detail, and depth. And Icon has no color, less depth, and seems much more stran, even a little angry. & 3-D. not Flat

B. Sculpture — discuss

Sculpture first look — body, weight, and setting

- First describe pose, bodily weight, gaze, hands, clothing or nudity, and relationship to architecture. Then connect evidence to the Renaissance return to monumental human figures, anatomical study, classical examples, and civic or religious meaning.

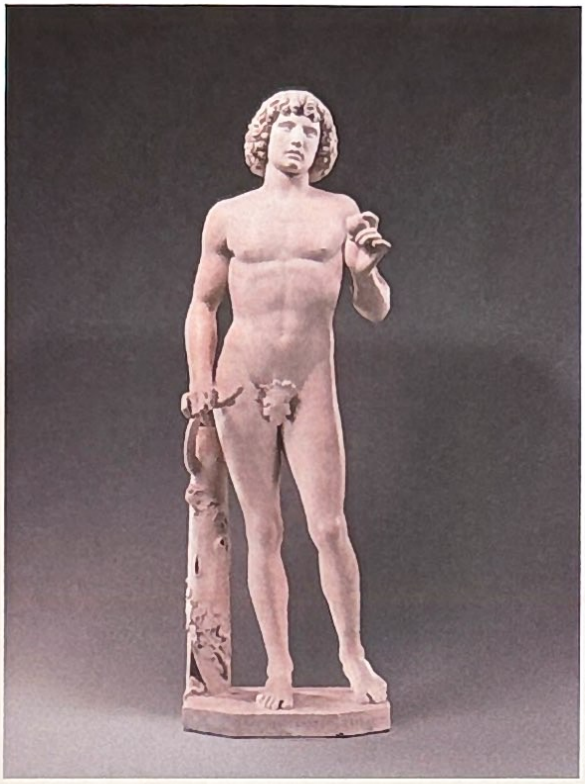
looks like he's smoldering / thinking. His right is on his right leg. Right hand scratching thigh while left hand Im not sure. He looks like he's gazing at a crowd maybe? and he is nude. classically. It references the topic with nudity and his relaxed pose.

Example — Michelangelo, David (1501–1504)

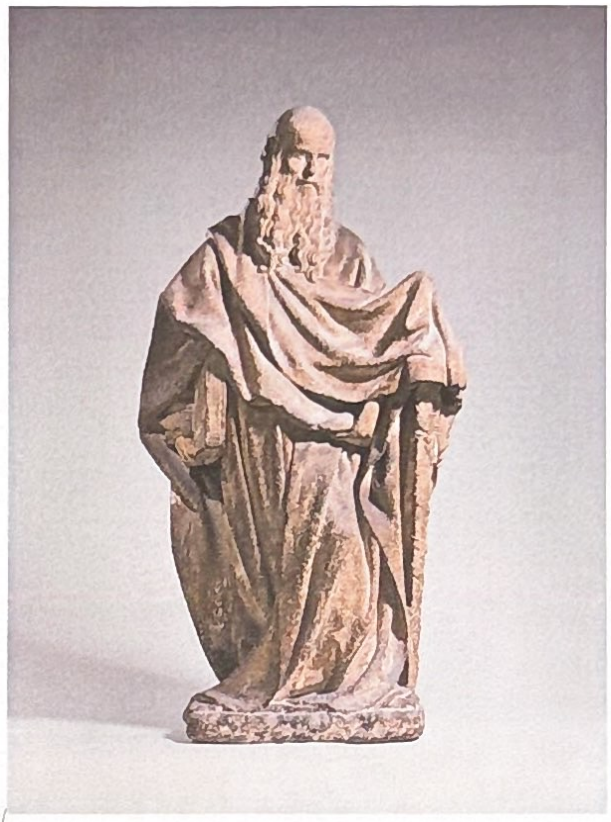


Describe the distribution of weight, the hands, and the direction of the gaze. Which leg bears more weight? Right leg

MET SCULPTURE COMPARISON — Use the two Metropolitan Museum of Art images printed below: Tullio Lombardo, Adam, and Saint Paul (Circle of Claus de Werve). Compare clothing and bodily weight; identify the biblical or Christian subject that remains. Discuss orally.



Tullio Lombardo, Adam, ca. 1490–95. Marble. The Metropolitan Museum of Art.



Saint Paul, Circle of Claus de Werve, ca. 1420–30. Limestone with traces of paint. The Metropolitan Museum of Art.

- Standing
- nude, leaf covering genetals
- holding a branch?
- weight on front forefoot
- curly hair
- First man on earth according to Christian thought.

- Fully clothed with drapes/Robe
- bald w/ long beard
- either sitting or very short
- heavily spread early Christian
- looks like he is resting?

C. Architecture — discuss

Architecture first look — structure, geometry, and function

- First identify arches, ribs, columns, domes, windows/light, symmetry, and whether the space appears church, civic, or public.
- After looking, compare the visible features: Gothic churches commonly emphasize pointed arches, rib vaults, stained glass, and strong vertical lines; Renaissance architects increasingly revive classical columns, round arches, domes, symmetry, and proportional systems in churches, palaces, courtyards, and civic buildings.

Brief comparison — Brunelleschi's Dome, Florence Cathedral

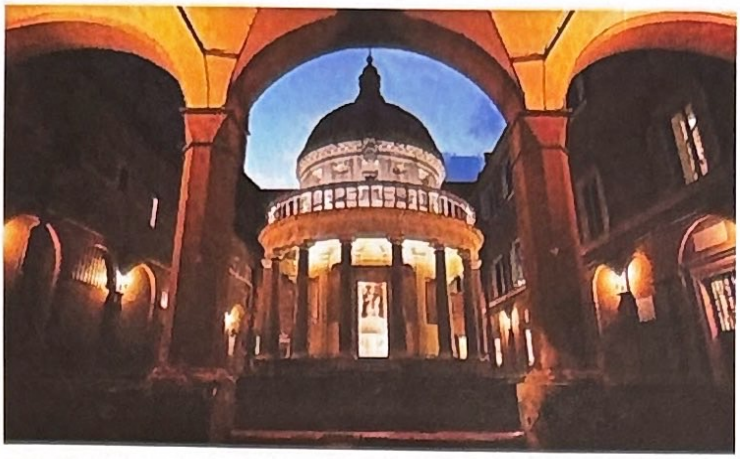
Describe the dome's shape, ribs, and relation to the surrounding cathedral. Which features distinguish it from a simple classical hemisphere?



- cross on top
- ribs around it
- holes?
- much less square & blocky than nearby cathedral

Example — Bramante, Tempietto (San Pietro in Montorio, Rome)

Identify the plan, columns, and dome. What can you infer about proportion from the two photographs?





- Pyramidal (stairs big and get smaller)
- Columns are about human sized
- Harmony of parts & everything goes together.

VISUAL EVIDENCE NOTES — One work per category: write a feature and its effect in 5–8 words per row.

CATEGORY / WORK	VISIBLE FEATURE → EFFECT
Painting — chosen work Creation of Adam	Adam's Arms Limpness ↳ shows trust God is trying & Adam isn't
Sculpture — chosen work David	Nudity ↳ shows Purity, individuality, and his vulnerability. No Armor!
Architecture — chosen work Tempietto	Pyramidal ↳ harmonizes all the elements of the Architecture into 1 Cohesive Structure.

HUMANISM AND THE RENAISSANCE INDIVIDUAL — Read before discussion

Human action — "The Renaissance saw the rise of a different argument - that your actions matter more and that you need to be in tune with who you are as a person. The era emphasized seeing what's unique in each person."

Exceptional lives — "The Renaissance wasn't looking at how people behaved in general, but about exceptional people, hearkening back to the Plutarch-type approach."

Human possibilities — "The spirit of the Renaissance, on the other hand, wanted to discover the different ways that human beings could live, in order to understand the horizons of the human spirit."

Opposition — "Some people opposed the movement, including Savonarola. Renaissance ideas spread over time, and popes differed in their support for them."

Discuss — Name one claim above about human action or individual lives. Which opponent is named? Connect one idea to a visible detail in an artwork orally.

WRITING PRACTICE — Choose one work. Write one sentence explaining how a visible feature supports your interpretation.

STOP!

REFERENCE — Donatello, St. George (Orsanmichele)
Describe the stance, shield, and gaze. How does this figure relate to its architectural setting?



in COA, Adams Face shows indifference he doesnt give about existance, God, or anything. hence why his Arm is relaxed while Gods is outstreched.

REFERENCE — St. Peter's Basilica, interior dome (Vatican)

Describe the dome's ribs, decoration, and windows. How is light distributed?



REFERENCE — Features to review after class

- Painting: identify a specific device—such as linear perspective, modeling, individualized expression, gold ground, or compressed space—and explain how it makes the scene devotional, bodily, ordered, or intellectually present.
- Sculpture: compare pose, bodily weight, tension, nudity or clothing, relationship to architecture, and classical reference; explain how these features make the human figure appear heroic, civic, or monumental.
- Architecture: compare actual structural or decorative features—pointed versus round arches, vaults, domes, columns, symmetry, light, and function—to explain how the building directs attention upward, inward, civic, or classical.

REFERENCE — Major Renaissance Figures

Dante — wrote major works in the vernacular and joined intense attention to human experience with Christian theology and classical learning.

Petrarch — recovered classical texts, including Cicero's letters; joined religious concerns with a love of active life; helped popularize the sonnet.

Boccaccio — wrote the Decameron in Italian: entertaining stories about human character, conduct, and behavior.

Leonardo da Vinci — Mona Lisa, Last Supper, and Vitruvian Man; artist, inventor, and scientific observer; a model of the "Renaissance man."

Michelangelo — sculptor, painter, architect, and poet; major works include David and the Sistine Chapel ceiling.

Raphael — School of Athens places ancient thinkers in a Renaissance architectural setting, with Plato and Aristotle at the center.

Machiavelli — wrote The Prince, which examines the actions of a real-world ruler rather than an ideal political order.

Medici family — powerful in Florentine politics and banking and important patrons; Machiavelli addressed The Prince to a Medici ruler.

Leonardo Bruni — wrote history in a revived Roman style and connected ancient learning to Florence's civic life and liberty.

Pico della Mirandola — searched for truth in the Bible, Greek philosophy, and other intellectual traditions; wrote the Oration on the Dignity of Man.

Luca Pacioli — Franciscan friar and mathematician who published a systematic description of double-entry bookkeeping in 1494.

Images: inherited art photographs and Metropolitan Museum of Art comparison images are printed in this packet with raw source links. Van Eyck's panels continue in Thursday's Northern Renaissance packet.